

others appreciate and enjoy dollops of each—a little recognition, some money, the pleasure of spending a day doing what one *likes*.

The day you sign up with a direct sales company, you're automatically an entrepreneur. This means you are on your own, running your own "shop" in the manner that suits you best. It will operate by your own set of rules and goal-setting strategies, and of course there'll be changes to deal with and information to decipher. Each day will call for *effort* to keep going, especially when things look confusing or bleak. When you're an entrepreneur, you clock in and out at your chosen hours and your company operates almost entirely on *your own steam*! No boss will check up on you, there's no traveling to an office, and there's no guaranteed check on Fridays. The company you build at your desk reflects who you are and how you think. You decide the limits and how much money you'll earn. You've got to be *motivated*!

When you're an entrepreneur, you'll be taking a number of risks. Risk taking may reward you with *success* when your efforts pay off. But taking risks can also bring rejection, teasing, and discouragement. In tougher times, you must call on your stronger self, shrug off negativity, and believe you're worthy and that what you're doing is worthwhile. I bring this point up again because it's so critical to winning in sales—you've got to roll with the punches and be guided by the force of your high *self-esteem*!

Surprisingly, many people think their self-esteem is *lower* than it is. I've listened to thousands of stories over the years of successful women and men who joined the sale business originally believing they'd fail. Barbara Hammond, the Home Interiors vice president mentioned earlier, told me, "Sometimes I meet women who've signed up with us and I discover that we are the *only ones* to have ever encouraged them to achieve something for themselves," she said. "I found there are so few women who *believe* in themselves, or think they even *have* potential."